

25 Things About Life I Wish I Had Known 10 Years Ago

1. **Struggle Is Good.** Never say "I can't take it anymore." Say "Bring it on!"
2. **Don't Complain.** Complaining is the biggest waste of time there is. Either do something about it, and if you can't, shut up about it.
3. **Spend Time with People You Love.** That's your family and best friends. If you don't have a family, create one. Most people in life are only visitors. Family is for life.
4. **Don't Start A Relationship If You're Not in Love.** I've done this more than once. You kind of like someone and think: "We might as well give it a shot." Not a good idea. You're either in love, or you are not. Don't fool yourself. It's not fair to you and the other person.
5. **Exercise Daily.** I didn't get this until recently. A healthy body is where you have to start everything in life. If you can't build a healthy and strong body, what CAN you build in life?
6. **Keep a Journal.** No, keeping a journal is not for children. It helps you to become a better thinker and writer. "I don't want to be a writer" you might think. Well, how many emails and texts do you send a day? Everybody is a writer.
7. **Be Grateful.** Say 'thank you' to everyone and everything. "Thank you for this beautiful day." "Thank you for your email." "Thank you for being there for me."
8. **Don't Care About What People Think.** We all die in the end, do you really think it matters what people think of you?
9. **Take More Risks.** Don't be such a wimp.
10. **Pick an Industry, Not A Job.** If you want to become good

- 11. Lead the Way.** When you find yourself in a situation where everyone looks at each other, it's time for you to lead. You're a leader when you decide to become one. There's no initiation or a title. Just a decision.
- 12. Money Isn't Important.** It really isn't. But you have to train yourself not to care about money. Don't become too dependent on the stuff you own—otherwise, the stuff will own you.
- 13. Be Nice.** I don't mean you should be a pushover. You can be someone that doesn't take shit and be nice about it. Just don't insult people, think you're better than them, or act like an idiot.
- 14. Learn Every Day.** You've got to train your brain to stay alert. You don't have to read a book a day to learn every day. Learn from your mistakes. Learn from the people around you—be open to what they can teach you.
- 15. Rest Before You Are Tired.** Even if you love your job, and every day seems like a holiday, you need to take time to rest. You're a human and not an android, never forget that.
- 16. Don't Judge.** Just because people make different choices than you, they are not stupid. Also, you don't know everything about people, so don't judge them—help them.
- 17. Think About Others.** Just be mindful, that's all. We all have families, bills to pay, and our own issues. Don't always make everything about yourself.
- 18. Give Without Expecting Something in Return.** Don't keep score. You will become a bitter person if you do that. Give solely for the joy of giving. If you get something in return, great, if you don't, great.
- 19. There's No End Game.** We, as species, just *are*. Don't try to figure it all out. Enjoy your journey.
- 20. Enjoy Small Things.** I like clichés because they are true. Especially this one. You know why? Everyone says they

- 21. Don't Take Yourself So Seriously.** Yeah, yeah, you're an individual, and people have to take you seriously, I get it. But at the end of the day, we're all a bunch of ants trying to chase the same things. Lighten up.
- 22. Don't Blame People.** What's the point? Do you want to punish them? You don't do that to people. Also don't blame yourself—you're only human.
- 23. Create Something.** Not to leave a legacy, you won't be here to see it anyway, but to be of use. Make music, write a book, build a table, anything. You'll feel good about yourself, plus you give something back to people to use or enjoy.
- 24. Never Look Back Too Long.** Reflecting on the past is only good for one thing: Learning.
- 25. Take Action.** Don't just sit there, do something. Without action, there is no outcome.

You might know a lot. But like Socrates, you and I know nothing at all. So we have to keep learning.